

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	01 October 2026
Team ID	[TEAM ID]
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem: After a Standard Laptop request is approved, the Hardware team needs a Catalog Task with the correct task details and ownership. The project explores different ways to automate or manage this post-approval hand-off.

Team Brainstorm — Ideas by Member

Vishal M — Team Lead

- Business Rule: create a Catalog Task when the Requested Item reaches an approved state.
- Scheduled Job: periodically identify approved Standard Laptop items without a task and create one.
- Manual process: procurement staff create and assign the Catalog Task after approval.

Hari Prasath M — Member

- Flow Designer: trigger from the Service Catalog approval flow and create the Catalog Task automatically.
- Assignment Rule: route the resulting task to the Hardware assignment group using task conditions.
- UI Action: give an authorized user a controlled action to create the hardware task from the Requested Item.

Jenusha Fredrin J — Member

- Email-based handoff: send an approval email containing the request details to the Hardware team for task processing.
- IntegrationHub / Orchestration: use a reusable automation/integration action to create or route the hardware work.
- SLA reminder: monitor approved requests and remind or escalate when hardware action has not started.

Amudhan A S — Member

- Flow Designer with standardized task fields: create the task with a fixed short description and Hardware assignment.
- Business Rule with validation: prevent duplicate task creation when an approved item is processed.
- Scheduled exception check: report approved requests that still have no Catalog Task.

Team Discussion Outcome

The team identified multiple genuinely different approaches rather than treating individual Flow Designer configuration steps as separate ideas. The alternatives were compared for feasibility and importance to the post-approval procurement problem.

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization — Idea Listing

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Distinct solution approaches generated by the team. Flow Designer sub-actions such as Hardware assignment are intentionally not treated as separate solutions.

1. Flow Designer

ServiceNow Flow Designer creates the Catalog Task after approval and assigns the task to Hardware.

2. Business Rule

A server-side Business Rule detects the approved Requested Item and creates the required Catalog Task.

3. Assignment Rule

A task Assignment Rule determines the Hardware group from the task/request conditions.

4. UI Action

An authorized user launches a controlled UI Action from the Requested Item to create the hardware task.

5. Scheduled Job

A scheduled process checks approved Standard Laptop items and creates missing Catalog Tasks.

6. Email-Based Handoff

Approval sends an email containing request details to the Hardware team for follow-up processing.

7. IntegrationHub / Orchestration

A reusable integration/orchestration action handles the post-approval task creation or routing.

8. SLA Reminder / Escalation

An SLA tracks approved requests awaiting hardware action and sends reminders or escalations.

9. Manual Process

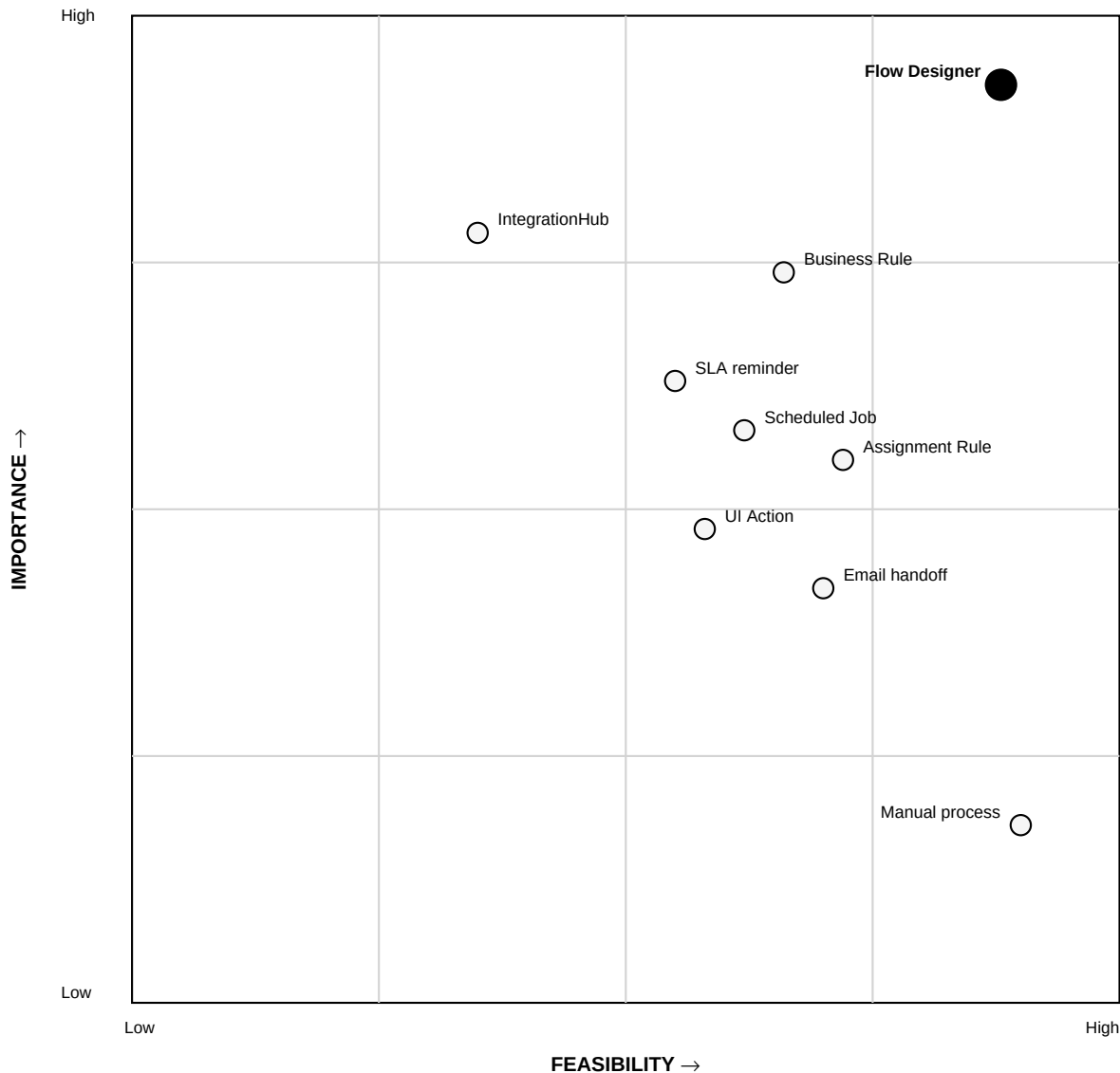
Procurement staff manually create and assign the Catalog Task after approval.

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization — Prioritization

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Only distinct solutions are plotted. Feasibility represents implementation effort/complexity in the ServiceNow context; importance represents how directly the approach solves the approved-request-to-Hardware hand-off problem.



Selected Idea: Flow Designer

Flow Designer is selected because it provides a direct approval-driven workflow inside ServiceNow, creates the Catalog Task automatically, and supports consistent routing to Hardware without requiring a separate manual hand-off.

Reason for Selection — Comparison

Compared with the manual process, Flow Designer removes the repeated task-creation step. Compared with an email-based handoff, it creates a trackable Catalog Task in ServiceNow instead of relying on a separate message and manual follow-up. Compared with a scheduled job, it can act directly after approval rather than waiting for a scheduled check.